

Planned & Unplanned Routes

Module 3 Revision Guide | Rule Book: TW1 §29–30

Source: EMR PPT 11-04 & GERT8000-TW1 Issue 22

1. Key Definitions

Planned Diversion

A planned diversion is where the planned route of a train is altered and an alternative route is provided.

It can be either:

- Planned well in advance — published in the Weekly Operating Notice (WON), shown on the train diagram or schedule card. You should check this on booking on.
- Short notice — notification comes from one of the following sources:
 - Operations Control
 - Signaller
 - Guard or Conductor
 - Being stopped at a junction signal

Unplanned Diversion

An unplanned diversion arises without advance notice, typically due to an incident, obstruction, or operational necessity. It will always come as short-notice notification from one of the same sources above.

2. Before Accepting a Diversion

Before you accept a diversion onto a route or section of line, you must satisfy yourself on several things:

Route Competency

- You must hold route knowledge (route competence) for the diverted portion — this means knowing the permissible speeds, signal locations, and station locations for that section.
- If you do NOT hold route knowledge, a route conductor must accompany you (see Section 4).
- You must check with the guard/conductor that they are also competent for the route, or that arrangements have been made.

Train & Infrastructure Suitability

You must also consider:

- Train length and formation — will the train fit in the relevant platforms and sidings?
- Siding lengths — relevant if you are being held in a loop or siding on the diverted route.
- Platform lengths — at any intermediate or terminal station on the diverted route.
- Train type authorisation — is your rolling stock type cleared to operate on the diverted line?
Not all routes are cleared for all traction/rolling stock types.

3. Route Clearance

Driver's Responsibility (TW1 §29.1)

Ensuring your train is cleared to run over a route is YOUR responsibility as the driver.

You must check the Sectional Appendix to confirm:

- That the route is cleared for your rolling stock type.
- Any specific speed restrictions applicable to your traction type on that route.
- Any other relevant operational restrictions.

Important: Do not rely solely on the signaller or operations controller to know what rolling stock types are authorised on a route. They may not have that information.

The Sectional Appendix is your reference document. It must be consulted when there is any doubt about whether your train is authorised to operate on the diverted route.

4. Route Knowledge Requirements (TW1 §29)

4.1 Driver Requirements (§29.1)

As the driver, you must have route knowledge for the entire route being operated over. If you do not, one of the following must apply:

- You are accompanied by a competent conductor driver who holds route knowledge for the portion you do not sign.

Conductor Driver Duties (TW1 §29.1)

When a conductor driver accompanies a driver over an unfamiliar portion:

- The conductor driver takes responsibility for safe working over that portion.
- The conductor driver must observe all signals and speed restrictions throughout.
- The conductor driver must drive the train over that portion if they are authorised and competent to do so.

Information the conductor driver must give to the driver:

- Signal locations
- Speed restrictions

- Gradients
- Curves
- Any other relevant line features

If you are acting as conductor driver over a line you are unfamiliar with, you must note signals, speed restrictions, and other line features to give to the driver.

4.2 Guard Requirements (§29.2)

- The guard must have route knowledge for the route being operated over, OR be accompanied by a person who holds route knowledge for that route.
- This applies in the same way as the driver requirement — the guard cannot operate over an unfamiliar route without appropriate knowledge or an accompanying qualified person.

5. Conducting Trains on EMR

On East Midlands Railway, where a driver does not hold route knowledge for a portion of the route:

- A route conductor is provided — this person must be driver competent and must sign (hold route knowledge for) the route in question.
- On EMR, the conductor driver drives the portion they sign — they take the driving seat for the section they are competent for, not just advise from the secondman seat.

Cab Etiquette When Being Conducted

If you are the driver being conducted over a section:

- Do not become a distraction to the conductor driver. They are driving and must concentrate on the route.
- Follow cab etiquette — no unnecessary conversation or activity that could divert attention.
- Your focus should be on the unfamiliar route — take note of signals, speed boards, and line features for your own learning and future competency.

6. Route-Proving Trains (TW1 §30)

Route proving is carried out after an incident or event that may have affected the line — such as severe weather, a derailment, or flooding — to check that the line is safe before normal traffic resumes.

6.1 Before Route Proving (§30.1)

Before entering the affected section to route prove, you must contact the signaller and agree the following:

- The route that needs to be proved.
- Whether adjacent lines within that route are also to be proved from the train.

- Where the train will operate to (the proving limit).
- Whether additional staff are travelling on the train or in the cab, and who they are.
- The arrangements for reporting back the state of the route once proving is complete.

You must stop the route-proving train at the protecting signal and wait for the signaller's agreement on all the above before proceeding.

6.2 During Route Proving (§30.2)

Once agreed and authorised to proceed, during route proving you must:

- Examine the line at caution — do not rush.
- Not exceed any speed specified by the signaller.
- Look out for: damage, debris, distortion, and any other issues affecting safe passage of trains.
- Observe the state of adjacent lines if instructed by the signaller.

If you find the line is blocked or partially blocked:

- Inform the signaller immediately of which lines are affected and how they are affected.

Once route proving is complete:

- Contact the signaller to confirm the route is clear and safe for the passage of trains.

If Staff Need to Alight During Route Proving

If staff on board tell you they need to get off the train to help clear the route or inspect infrastructure:

- Tell the signaller that staff will be alighting from the train.
- Agree with the staff that the train will remain at a stand until they are back on board.
- Wait for the signaller to give you authority to move before proceeding.

7. Quick Reference Summary

Topic	Key Point
Planned diversion (advance)	Published in WON; shown on diagram/schedule card. Check on booking on.
Planned diversion (short notice)	From: Ops Control / Signaller / Guard or Conductor / Stopped at junction signal.
Before accepting diversion	Check route competency, train type authorisation, siding/platform lengths.
Route clearance responsibility	Driver's responsibility — check Sectional Appendix. Don't rely on signaller/controller.
No route knowledge?	Must be accompanied by a competent conductor driver (TW1

	§29.1).
Conductor driver must give you	Signals, speeds, gradients, curves, other line features.
On EMR — conducting	Conductor must be driver competent and sign the route. They drive the portion.
Guard route knowledge	Guard must sign route or be accompanied by someone who does (TW1 §29.2).
Route proving — before	Contact signaller; agree route, adjacent lines, limit, staff, reporting (TW1 §30.1).
Route proving — during	Proceed at caution, don't exceed agreed speed, report line state to signaller (TW1 §30.2).

8. Revision Q&A

All questions and answers are sourced directly from EMR PPT 11-04 and TW1 (GERT8000-TW1 Issue 22).

Q: What is the difference between a planned and an unplanned diversion?

A: A planned diversion is where the route is altered and an alternative route is provided. It may be planned in advance (published in the WON) or given at short notice. An unplanned diversion arises without advance notice due to an operational incident or necessity.

Q: If you receive a short-notice planned diversion, who can notify you?

A: Operations Control, the signaller, the guard or conductor, or you may be informed by being stopped at a junction signal.

Q: If a diversion is published in advance, where would you find it?

A: It would be published in the Weekly Operating Notice (WON). It may also appear on your train diagram or schedule card, so you should check on booking on.

Q: Before accepting a diversion, what must you check regarding route competency?

A: You must check that you hold route knowledge for the diverted portion — knowing permissible speeds, signal locations, and station locations. If you don't hold that knowledge, you cannot accept the diversion without a competent conductor driver accompanying you.

Q: Whose responsibility is it to ensure the train is cleared to run over a diverted route?

A: It is the driver's responsibility. You must check the Sectional Appendix. You cannot rely on the signaller or operations controller to know what rolling stock types are authorised on the route.

Q: What additional factors must a driver consider before accepting a diversion?

A: Train length and formation, siding lengths, platform lengths at any stations on the diverted route, and whether the rolling stock type is authorised to operate on that route.

Q: Under TW1 §29.1, what must a driver do if they do not hold route knowledge for part of their route?

A: They must be accompanied by a competent conductor driver who holds route knowledge for that portion. The conductor driver takes responsibility for safe working over that section.

Q: What information must a conductor driver provide to the driver?

A: Signal locations, speed restrictions, gradients, curves, and any other relevant line features on the route being conducted over.

Q: On EMR, what happens when a conductor is provided for a portion of route?

A: The conductor must be driver competent and must sign (hold route knowledge for) that route. On EMR, the conductor driver drives the portion they sign — they take the driving seat for that section.

Q: Under TW1 §29.2, what is the guard's requirement regarding route knowledge?

A: The guard must hold route knowledge for the route being operated over, or be accompanied by a person who has route knowledge for that route.

Q: When is route proving carried out?

A: After an incident or event that may have affected the safety of the line — such as severe weather, a derailment, flooding, or an obstruction — to confirm the line is safe before normal traffic resumes.

Q: Under TW1 §30.1, what must you agree with the signaller before starting route proving?

A: You must agree: (1) the route to be proved; (2) whether adjacent lines are to be proved; (3) where the train will operate to; (4) whether additional staff are on the train/in the cab; (5) the arrangements for reporting the state of the route once complete.

Q: During route proving, what must you look out for?

A: Damage, debris, distortion, and any other issues that may affect the safe passage of trains. You must also observe adjacent lines if instructed by the signaller.

Q: What must you do when route proving is complete?

A: Contact the signaller to confirm that the route is clear and safe for the passage of trains.

Q: During route proving, if staff on board say they need to alight to help clear the route, what must you do?

A: Tell the signaller that staff will be alighting. Agree with those staff that the train will remain at a stand until they are back on board. Then wait for the signaller's authority to move before proceeding.

Q: Why must you not become a distraction when being conducted over a route?

A: The conductor driver is driving and must concentrate on the unfamiliar route. Cab etiquette must be followed — unnecessary conversation or activity could divert their attention and compromise safety.

End of Revision Guide